

World Views and Aspirations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Communities in Canada, Grade 11

College Preparation (NBV3C)

Workplace Preparation (NBV3E)

OVERVIEW

“World Views and Aspirations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Communities in Canada” provides an opportunity for students to explore Indigenous beliefs, values, and ways of knowing, as reflected in the historical and contemporary experiences of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit in Canada. By gaining an understanding of the ways in which First Nations, Métis and Inuit histories, values, perspectives, traditions, and aspirations differ from those of non-Indigenous Canadians, students develop the ability to analyse and compare world views. They learn that understanding cultural diversity and differences in world views is a key component of cultural harmony and respectful relationships between First Nations, Métis, and Inuit and non-Indigenous Canadians. Students also reflect on how their personal world view affects how they interpret and interact with the world around them.

This course examines critical issues facing First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities. By exploring past and present aspects of colonialism, as well as the effect of government policies and actions on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit, students advance their understanding of the ongoing struggle for decolonization and of the resiliency of Indigenous peoples in Canada. This knowledge and insight enables students to become critically thoughtful and informed citizens who can help promote reconciliation in Canada.

STRANDS

This course has four strands. Strand A, Research and Inquiry Skills, is followed by three content strands, which are organized thematically. Although strand A is presented separately from the areas of learning presented in strands B–D, teachers should ensure that students develop their research and inquiry skills in appropriate ways as they work to achieve the curriculum expectations in the other strands of the course.

A. Research and Inquiry Skills

Strand A focuses on developing students' ability to apply the inquiry process to investigate the beliefs and historical and contemporary experiences of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit in Canada. Students gather, interpret, and analyse evidence and information from a variety of primary and secondary sources, including Indigenous knowledge sources; synthesize their findings and formulate conclusions; and communicate the results of their research. This process and related skills apply to, and should be developed in conjunction with, the content of all the other strands of the course. Educators are encouraged to refer to the general discussion of the research and inquiry process that appears in the introduction to this document (see [page 24](#)) for necessary information relating to all First Nations, Métis, and Inuit studies courses.

B. Understanding and Respecting World Views and Cultural Diversity

In strand B, students explore the concept of world view and the role of a world view, or belief system, in daily life. By examining the elements, purposes, and functions of a world view in the context of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, students learn to identify distinct and common elements and develop their appreciation of both cultural uniqueness and shared humanity. Students deepen their understanding of how language, culture, and the relationship between people and place shape and reflect First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, identifying key elements of the beliefs, values, and customs of diverse cultural groups. Students gain an understanding of and respect for the diversity of cultural protocols, traditional values, and belief systems. Students also learn to use cultural awareness skills and strategies appropriately when exploring First Nations, Métis, and Inuit ways of knowing, world views, and contributions to society.

C. Colonization and Decolonization

In strand C, students develop their understanding of the concept of colonialism and of the past and present impact of colonization and associated government policies in Canada, gaining an understanding of how relations between Indigenous and non-Indigenous peoples relate to current realities. Students think critically and creatively about issues of concern to Indigenous peoples and examine key concepts and goals related to decolonization and resilience. Students analyse various strategies to raise awareness of the impact of colonialist policies and to sustain First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, aspirations, and actions in the context of social change.

D. Reclamation and Reconciliation

Strand D focuses on the importance of building respectful and reciprocal relationships to support reconciliation between Indigenous peoples and Canadian society. By learning about how individuals, families, institutions, and communities are reclaiming a place for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs, values, and customs in contemporary life, students deepen their understanding of the critical importance of recognition and respect for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit knowledge, world views, and aspirations. Recognition and respect are the foundations of truth, reconciliation, and renewed nation-to-nation relationships. Students also examine how key First Nations, Métis, and Inuit aspirations for communities, for Canada, and for global society reflect traditional and contemporary beliefs and values, and analyse the role of social action in supporting those goals.

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Workplace Preparation

NBV3E

This course explores diverse knowledge, world views, and aspirations that shape the actions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities in Canada. Students will examine issues of identity facing First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities with respect to changing relationships with the land, nature, one another, and Canada. Students will explore their own and others' world views, and the factors that shape world views over time, to develop an understanding of how traditional and contemporary beliefs and values influence the aspirations and practices of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities. Students are given the opportunity to develop further understanding about the impacts of colonization and how reconciling diverse knowledge, world views, and aspirations contributes to a call for societal understanding.

Prerequisite: First Nations, Métis, and Inuit in Canada, Grade 10, Open, or Canadian History since World War I, Grade 10, Academic or Applied, or the Grade 10 locally developed compulsory credit (LDCC) course in history

A. RESEARCH AND INQUIRY SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore topics related to the knowledge, world views, and aspirations that shape the actions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities, identifying key concepts and formulating critical questions to guide their research and inquiry;
- A2. Investigating:** create research plans, and locate and select information relevant to their chosen topics from a variety of sources, using appropriate research and inquiry methods and respecting Indigenous knowledge and ways of knowing;
- A3. Processing Information:** assess, record, analyse, and synthesize information gathered through research and inquiry, respecting Indigenous knowledge and ways of knowing;
- A4. Communicating and Reflecting:** communicate the results of their research and inquiry clearly and effectively, and reflect on and evaluate their research, inquiry, and communication skills.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** explore a variety of themes related to the knowledge, world views, and aspirations that shape the actions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities (*e.g., the role of Indigenous ecological knowledge, or IEK, in natural resource management; cultural protocols in the workplace; the role of Indigenous women and two-spirited people in contemporary communities; the purpose and processes of restorative justice; First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit approaches to community financial/economic management*) to identify topics for research and inquiry

- A1.2** identify key concepts related to their selected topics (*e.g., through listening, discussion, brainstorming, the use of visual organizers*)

Sample questions: “What might you put at the centre of your Venn diagram of Inuit values?” “What are some key concepts in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit approaches to natural resource management?”

- A1.3** formulate effective questions to guide their research and inquiry

Sample questions: “What questions might guide your research if you were exploring how First Nations, Métis, or Inuit beliefs and values related to justice could be applied in a community

setting such as a workplace or a volunteer organization?” “How might you change the questions you have developed to narrow the focus of your research?” “As you investigate economic management and development in different First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities, how might you use questions to structure your inquiry?”

A2. Investigating

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** create appropriate research plans to investigate their selected topics (*e.g., outline purpose and method; identify sources of information; develop research tools such as surveys, questionnaires, or interviews*), ensuring that their plans apply the principles of intent, reciprocity, and respect and that they acknowledge Indigenous ways of knowing and related protocols (*e.g., intent: clearly articulate the motivation for and purpose of the project; assess the consequences of the investigation for ancestors, future generations, and/or the natural world; reciprocity: plan to share the process and results of their investigation at all stages, to give and receive information, and to listen to and speak with those who may be affected by the work; engage in sustained mutual relationship building; respect: explain how they will acknowledge the connections between the human, natural, physical, spiritual, cultural, and/or*

emotional contexts of the topic; identify which types of knowledge can or cannot be shared, and seek informed consent from Indigenous individuals and/or communities when necessary)

Sample questions: “What is the purpose of your investigation? What methods will you use to look for information?” “What consequences might your investigation have for the individuals you consult? What steps can you take to ensure that they have given you informed consent to record and share the information? What types of information might they choose not to share with you? Why?” “Why is the practice of gift giving when seeking knowledge, guidance, or advice important?” “How might you focus your research on business start-ups in First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit communities?”

A2.2 locate and select information relevant to their investigations from a variety of primary and/or secondary sources, including Indigenous knowledge sources (e.g., primary sources: *interviews; surveys and questionnaires; statistics; legislation and treaties; work manuals; original media such as photographs, land registries, logs and journals, political cartoons, art works, songs, stories, posters*; secondary sources: *short and/or documentary films, conference papers or news articles, summaries of court cases, most podcasts, most websites, textbooks*)

Sample questions: “What is an example of an Indigenous knowledge source?” “Why should you consult both primary and secondary sources in your investigation?” “Why might you consult an Indigenous community or individual? What could these sources contribute to your investigation?”

A2.3 based on preliminary research, formulate a hypothesis, thesis statement, or critical question for each investigation, and use it to focus their inquiry

A3. Processing Information

Throughout this course, students will:

A3.1 assess various aspects of information gathered from Indigenous and non-Indigenous knowledge sources, using general research criteria (e.g., *accuracy, relevance, reliability, inherent values and bias, voice*) and respecting Indigenous world views and ways of knowing (e.g., *avoiding claims of universality, hierarchical knowledge, and/or exclusive authority; acknowledging social, historical, economic, and political context; demonstrating an understanding that the perspectives expressed in diverse knowledge sources are shaped by world views that may challenge one another*)

Sample questions: “What points in this newspaper article relate to your topic?” “When was this source produced, and who produced it? How might these factors influence its reliability?” “Whose perspectives are represented in this source? Whose voice is missing? What other perspectives might make the material more relevant to your inquiry?” “How can you check whether this website contains accurate information? Is it representative of the Indigenous perspectives or peoples you are investigating? Why, or why not?”

A3.2 record and organize information and key ideas using a variety of formats (e.g., *notes, graphic organizers, summaries, audio/digital records*)

A3.3 analyse and interpret research information (e.g., *compare information provided in written documents, oral stories, and interviews; determine whether common themes arise in different sources*)

Sample questions: “How does the information in these two interviews on your topic differ? What do the differences reveal? How are the sources the same? What do these common themes suggest about your topic?”

A3.4 demonstrate academic honesty by documenting the sources of all information generated through research

A3.5 synthesize findings and formulate conclusions (e.g., *weigh and connect information to determine the answer to their research question; assess the extent to which their findings may be affected by factors not included in their research design; determine whether their results support or contradict their hypothesis*)

Sample questions: “What connections did you find in the information you gathered about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives on humans and on nature?” “Which of your sources suggests that the environmental impact of this [mine/pipeline] built on [First Nations/Métis/Inuit] land was justified by the benefits? Which sources suggest the opposite? Do any of the sources represent the [First Nations/Métis/Inuit] perspective and relationship to the land accurately? Which assessments do you find more persuasive, and why?”

A4. Communicating and Reflecting

Throughout this course, students will:

A4.1 use an appropriate format (e.g., *oral presentation, graph, brochure, flyer, poster, multimedia presentation, web page, spreadsheet*)

to communicate the results of their research and inquiry effectively for a specific purpose and audience

Sample questions: “How might you use a flow chart to show the relationships between the spiritual, human, and natural worlds?” “In what way could sketchnotes help you select key ideas about Indigenous protocols related to a community celebration and illustrate their meanings?” “How might you use graphs to summarize your information about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit business start-ups?”

- A4.2** use correctly terms and phrases related to various First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views and experiences (e.g., *Indigenous, First Nations, Métis, Inuit, creation, community, historic Métis communities, Métis root ancestors, Indigenous ecological knowledge, nationhood, traditional medicines, self-governance, traditional knowledge, traditional territory, ethnogenesis*)

Sample questions: “What does ‘nationhood’ mean in a First Nations context?” “What similarities and differences are there between the term ‘Senator’ in a Métis context and the term ‘Elder’ in a First Nations or Inuit context?” “What is Indigenous ecological knowledge? How is it the same as or different from other forms of ecological knowledge?”

- A4.3** clearly communicate the results of their inquiries (e.g., *write coherently, organize ideas logically, use language conventions properly*), and follow documentation conventions for acknowledging sources (e.g., *generate a bibliography or a reference list in APA style, use footnotes or endnotes, include in-text author-date citations, provide a credits list for illustrative material*)

- A4.4** demonstrate an understanding of the general research and inquiry process by reflecting on and evaluating their own research, inquiry, and communication skills, while respecting Indigenous knowledge and ways of knowing

Sample questions: “In what ways did the information you gathered confirm or contradict what you already knew about the topic? How does this new information change your understanding?” “In what ways did First Nations, Métis, and Inuit knowledge sources give you a deeper understanding of your topic?”

B. UNDERSTANDING AND RESPECTING WORLD VIEWS AND CULTURAL DIVERSITY

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Concept of World View:** demonstrate an understanding of the elements, purposes, and functions of a world view or belief system, and explore the role of world view in daily life in Canada;
- B2. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit World Views:** demonstrate an understanding of how language, culture, and the relationship between people and place shape and reflect First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, identifying key elements of the beliefs, values, and customs associated with diverse cultures;
- B3. Cultural Awareness Skills and Strategies:** use cultural awareness skills and strategies appropriately when exploring First Nations, Métis, and Inuit ways of knowing, world views, and contributions to society.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Concept of World View

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** identify several different elements of a world view or belief system (*e.g., beliefs about creation, the relationship between humanity and the natural world, existence after death; ways of giving thanks; kinship and family structures; rites of passage; forms of governance; criteria for community membership, approaches to economic sustainability and prosperity*), providing examples from more than one culture

Sample questions: “What are some ways of giving thanks in different cultures?” “What are some typical elements of a world view that explain and/or regulate human relationships?”

- B1.2** compare their own and at least one other world view to identify some common purposes and functions of a belief system (*e.g., as a framework for thinking about the meaning of life; a set of values on which to base decisions and behaviour; as the foundation of individual and collective identity; as a guide to interactions with others*)

Sample questions: “What example can you give of a time when your world view helped you make an important decision?” “How does your world view influence your sense of identity?”

“Think of a specific belief you learned from your community. What are some other communities or cultures that share this belief? Why do you think different cultures often have beliefs in common?” “How do your beliefs and values influence the way you make financial decisions? How is this the same as or different from the approach to financial decision making you can identify in another culture, community, or family?”

- B1.3** explain how several different aspects of daily life and common aspirations in Canada are shaped by and reflect specific beliefs and values (*e.g., with reference to land ownership, core community values, social acceptance, individual identity, education, marriage, adoption, birth*), identifying some similarities and differences between Indigenous and non-Indigenous beliefs and values

Sample questions: “What beliefs are reflected in Canadian federal policies on resource development? In what ways do these beliefs differ from those held by some First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities in Canada?” “What beliefs and values influence how animal rights groups view the harvesting of animals? How does this differ from the beliefs and values of the Métis Nation?” “How does the

Nunavut government’s approach to keeping communities safe from polar bears reflect shared Indigenous and non-Indigenous beliefs and knowledge about animal conservation?”

B2. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit World Views

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 identify some common elements of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs and customs (e.g., beliefs: *about creation, inheritance, marriage, animals, the human relationship with the natural world, two-spiritedness*; customs: *birthing and naming practices, acknowledging traditional lands, smudging, traditional uses of plants and animals, community gift giving, storytelling, healing circles, ceremonial songs and dances*), and explain how they reflect a world view (e.g., *healing circles uphold a non-hierarchical world view that emphasizes respect and equality by giving everyone an equal chance to speak; stories that warn about greed reflect a world view in which current decisions and actions take future generations into account*)

Sample questions: “Where do warnings about greed appear in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit stories? What are some connections between this theme and beliefs about the environment and planning for future generations?” “What are some traditional uses of plants and animals in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities? Although these uses vary across Canada, what do they have in common? What beliefs do these traditional uses demonstrate?” “How does the Métis story of the giving tree reflect community values? What examples of similar values can you find in other Indigenous cultures?” “What role has music historically played in a Métis world view? In which other Indigenous cultures does music have a similar role?” “What common belief about the relationship between humans, animals, and nature does the Dene story of Caribou Boy illustrate?”

B2.2 make and explain inferences about how the use of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit languages sustains cultural values and identities (e.g., *songs in Indigenous languages express the sacred relationship between the people and the land; when some First Nations and Métis individuals introduce themselves in an Indigenous language they affirm their spiritual and collective identity by acknowledging their spirit name along with their clan, community, and nation*)

Sample questions: “Why do many First Nations, Métis, and Inuit consider it imperative to revitalize Indigenous languages?” “What kind

of information do individuals provide when referring to their ancestral or spiritual name, clan, community, and nation? How does this practice support cultural values and cultural identity?”

B2.3 describe and compare the roles of several different significant figures associated with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit belief systems (e.g., *with reference to Grandmother Moon and Grandfather Sun; the Windigo in Anishinaabe tradition and the Rougarou in Métis culture; Sky Woman in Haudenosaunee tradition and Raven in the Haida creation story; Nuliajuk in Inuit stories and Kumugwe in Kwakwaka’wakw tradition*)

Sample questions: “What is the role of the Windigo, and which culture is this figure associated with? How is the Windigo similar to or different from Nanabush, Nanbozho, Coyote, and the Weetigo in other First Nations communities?” “What connections can you make between the Métis story of the Rougarou and the figure of Windigo? What do these connections suggest about the nature of storytelling?” “What do Grandmother Moon and Grandfather Sun convey about First Nations relationships with the Earth? What similar things do they teach their community members? How do they differ?” “How does the figure of Akhlut in Inuit stories connect land and sea? In your opinion, what is the purpose of such a figure? What similar figure from another Indigenous culture can you identify?” “What do Métis stories about Ti-Jean teach about values? What figure might you compare Ti-Jean to?”

B2.4 identify several different locations that are significant in the world views of various First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities, and explain the beliefs and/or values that have been and continue to be associated with those sites (e.g., *members of the Hiawatha First Nation believe that the Serpent Mounds at Rice Lake play a role in directing the spirits of the dead; Inuit shamans of Nunatsiavut [Labrador] used to travel to the Torngat Mountains to communicate with the spirit world, and community members still go to these mountains to find a sense of self*)

Sample questions: “Why are youth from the Métis Nation of Ontario retracing the portages of their ancestors? What is the significance of waterways within a Métis world view? What values does this contemporary use of waterways express?” “How is storytelling being used by First Story Toronto? What does this urban-based storytelling tell us about the ways in which land resources were used historically? What beliefs are associated with the site of what is now the city of Toronto?” “What is the significance of

Akikodijiwan (Chaudière Falls) and the adjacent islands to the Algonquins of Pikwàkanagàn First Nation? What vision of the falls and islands did Elder William Commanda have?”

B2.5 analyse some Indigenous ceremonies and other traditional practices in terms of how these practices help define individual and/or collective roles and responsibilities within a world view (e.g., *potlatch binds communities together in a celebration of sharing, distribution of wealth, and confirmation of social positions; the strawberry fast teaches young Haudenosaunee women about womanhood, love, and community; Inuit traditional sporting activities and games support community building and help hunters prepare for the hunting season by improving their physical strength*)

Sample questions: “What do young First Nations women learn during a strawberry fast, and in what ways? Why are these lessons important in a contemporary context?” “In the Nunavik region, how does the naming ceremony reflect Inuit beliefs about family?” “What roles do children, parents, and grandparents have during a Métis community hunt? What do these roles suggest about community values?”

B3. Cultural Awareness Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 identify some cultural awareness skills and strategies (e.g., *remaining open to different world views when comparing how current issues related to Indigenous communities are expressed in Indigenous and mainstream media; demonstrating respect for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities by exploring their histories and current aspirations prior to visiting cultural and/or historical sites located within their territories; identifying ways to respectfully confer with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals to ensure that their beliefs, values, and aspirations are included in a new school or community-based initiative; seeking mentoring relationships with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals to build understanding and knowledge*), and apply them when exploring First Nations, Métis, and Inuit ways of knowing, world views, and contributions to society

Sample questions: “How can you ensure that you are being respectful to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit community partners as you work on an initiative to make the realities faced by those communities more visible in your school or in a volunteer or work setting?” “What are some

ways to stay up to date about current issues affecting a local Indigenous community? How might you use your knowledge to support the inclusion of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit voices in school projects?” “Before you visit a cultural site on the territory of a local First Nation community, how should you prepare?” “How might you demonstrate respectful listening during a group discussion in which group members have diverse world views?”

B3.2 analyse some First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural works in terms of what they communicate about cultural identity and/or cross-cultural interaction (e.g., *explain how Annie Pootoogook’s art challenges viewers’ expectations about daily life in the Arctic; evaluate a poem or a short film by a First Nation, Métis, or Inuk writer/director as a response to cultural stereotyping; interpret the message about identity communicated by a clothing design that incorporates Indigenous cultural symbols*)

Sample questions: “What does this spoken-word performance by a First Nation youth communicate about the impact of racism? What do you think the performer wants you to understand?” “After selecting and viewing a short film from the Wapikoni Mobile catalogue, how do you think the work challenged some cultural stereotypes of First Nations identity? What message about cross-cultural interactions do you think the Indigenous youth who directed the film wanted to communicate?”

B3.3 explain how some policies regulating public institutions in Canada have challenged and continue to challenge Indigenous cultural practices (e.g., *fire codes may prohibit smudging in public facilities; workplace policy governing employees’ appearance may prevent Indigenous workers from wearing their hair long for cultural and spiritual reasons; the school calendar does not always accommodate seasonally specific cultural practices, such as hunting*), and suggest a few strategies to ensure that these institutions are inclusive (e.g., *developing smudging protocols and guidelines; creating more flexible/creative workplace guidelines; presenting invited guests with gifts or offerings; adjusting the school calendar in some communities to permit students to participate in community hunts*)

Sample questions: “What policies outlined in this workplace manual might affect the cultural identities of Indigenous employees? What practical strategy might you use to make this workplace more inclusive?” “How have some traditional Indigenous roles and responsibilities been affected by regulations

governing public facilities? How might such regulations be revised to accommodate these roles safely and appropriately?”

B3.4 design an initiative to build awareness of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and realities within the school community (*e.g., a student group to share ideas and perspectives on raising cross-cultural awareness within the school community; hosting a guest from a local Indigenous community to speak to the class or the whole school about the voices and perspectives of the community; a film festival or other arts event to increase awareness of the history, contemporary reality, and/or cultural protocols of a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit community*)

Sample questions: “What aspects of this community’s history and current reality do you want your exhibition to highlight?” “What aspects of using cultural protocols and developing cultural awareness do you want to address in your initiative?” “What could you do to encourage members of the school community to acknowledge the First Nations territory on which they live?” “How might you work with your teacher, principal, or the school community to incorporate Indigenous histories and current realities into school events such as Remembrance Day and Treaties Recognition Week?”

C. COLONIZATION AND DECOLONIZATION

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Colonialism and Colonization:** demonstrate an understanding of the concept of colonialism, and of the past and present impact of colonization and related government policies in Canada;
- C2. Decolonization, Resilience, and Social Change:** demonstrate an understanding of the key concepts and goals of decolonization and resilience, analysing various strategies to raise awareness of the impact of colonialist policies and to sustain First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, aspirations, and actions in the context of social change.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Colonialism and Colonization

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** demonstrate an understanding of the key concepts associated with colonialism, describing how these concepts were put into practice in what would be called Canada (*e.g., the concept of terra nullius assumed that First Nations territory was “nobody’s land”, or unclaimed land, ignoring First Nations sovereignty and permitting the forced relocation of Indigenous communities; the “civilizing mission” embodied the concept that it was a duty to impose European values, leading to the suppression of Indigenous languages and cultural and spiritual practices*)

Sample questions: “In what specific ways has the concept of *terra nullius* affected First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities in Canada?” “How has the concept of paternalism been used to justify the appropriation of First Nations territories?” “How have paternalistic policies challenged the role of clan mothers in First Nations matriarchal societies?”

- C1.2** explain some ways in which the concept of assimilation has been put into practice in Canada, and assess various consequences for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals, communities, world views, and aspirations (*e.g., with reference to the residential school system, “Indian” day schools, the Indian Act, the disc number system for Inuit, the Sixties Scoop*)

Sample questions: “How did the residential school system regulate the daily life of students? What effect did these policies have on the

world views and aspirations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit children and their families?” “How did the disc number system instituted by the federal government work? How did this system infringe on traditional Inuit naming practices? What connection can you make between the disc number system and the treatment of Inuit as First Nations within the scope of the Indian Act?” “How has the Indian Act used gender inequity as an assimilationist strategy? In what ways has the *Descheneaux* case directed the government to respond to discrimination in the Indian Act? What is the outcome to date?”

- C1.3** make and explain inferences about the use of political and judicial systems in Canada to enforce colonialist approaches to the ownership, development, and management of land and natural resources (*e.g., with reference to treaties, the federal scrip policy, specific and comprehensive land claims, the extinguishment of title, court cases*)

Sample questions: “How was the scrip system used to disperse the Métis? What colonialist concepts do you think motivated this policy?” “In your opinion, has the Manitoba government’s approach to the Nelson River Hydroelectric Project and the Wuskwatim hydroelectric project on Burntwood River been influenced by colonialist concepts? Why, or why not?” “In what ways did the federal government’s response to the Nunavut Land Claims Agreement attempt to enforce a colonialist relationship? How did *Nunavut Tunngavik Incorporated v. Canada*, 2014, challenge that position?”

C2. Decolonization, Resilience, and Social Change

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 demonstrate an understanding of the key goals of decolonization and resilience in the context of social change (*e.g., acknowledging the continuing effects of colonization; incorporating Indigenous perspectives into contemporary public policies; recognizing and respecting contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, aspirations, and actions; honouring treaty agreements; acknowledging the resilience of Indigenous communities, grassroots organizations, and youth, and supporting their role in shaping new societal perspectives; ensuring the quality of life of current and future generations; improving educational attainment; revitalizing culture and language; achieving self-determination through respectful relationships between Canadian governments and distinct Indigenous governments*)

Sample questions: “What does the term ‘decolonization’ mean? What role should contemporary Canadian society have in promoting decolonization? In what ways can Indigenous and non-Indigenous individuals work together to support this goal?” “How can learning about treaties, treaty territories, and traditional lands help develop awareness of the resilience of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit?” “How is the term ‘settler Canadian’ used in contemporary society? How is it significant in the context of decolonization?”

C2.2 identify and describe some initiatives to raise awareness of the continuing impact of colonialist policies in Canada (*e.g., processes and consultations with Indigenous governments and organizations to address issues related to education and training, health, environmental protection, challenges facing Indigenous women and girls, discrimination against two-spirited individuals; social media campaigns; teach-ins and protests*), and suggest appropriate ways to support these initiatives (*e.g., through workplace policies, volunteer work, participation in public forums*)

Sample questions: “What examples can you find of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit efforts to achieve specific decolonization goals? How might non-Indigenous individuals show support for these movements?” “In what ways does the Moose Hide Campaign address the continuing impact of colonialist policies on Indigenous women? What beliefs, values, and aspirations does the campaign reflect and support?” “In what specific ways does the *Final Report of the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada*

acknowledge the impact of colonization? How are some workplaces showing support for the commission’s recommendations?”

C2.3 identify and describe some First Nations, Métis, and Inuit initiatives to assert community control over local economic development and land use (*e.g., support for biological diversity and protection of sacred herbs and of native plant and wildlife species that are part of a traditional diet; the protection of sacred sites, natural resources, and water; community training in sustainable forestry management*), and make inferences about the beliefs, values, and/or aspirations that motivate these efforts

Sample questions: “What is the role of Nunavut Tunngavik Incorporated with respect to the management of land, water, and wildlife? How do these responsibilities reflect an Inuit world view?” “What are some ways in which section 35 of the Constitution Act has played a significant role in land development issues in Canada? What example can you give of a First Nation community referring to section 35 in support of its aspirations?” “What was the role of social media in anti-fracking protests at Elsipogtog First Nation in New Brunswick? What values motivated the campaign?” “How do Regional Consultation Committees involve Métis communities in Ontario in responding to local environmental issues and influencing economic development?”

C2.4 identify and describe some First Nations, Métis, and Inuit initiatives to address language loss (*e.g., using language nests, helping community members gain access to postsecondary language programs, promoting community-based language immersion programs, developing language programs in on-reserve schools*), and make inferences about the beliefs, values, and/or aspirations that motivate these efforts

Sample questions: “Why might Indigenous languages connect communities to their ancestral lands more closely than other languages can do?” “The Onkwawenna Kentyohkwa organization emphasizes that it not only teaches language but also creates speakers. Why is that approach important with respect to Indigenous language loss? What techniques does the program use?” “What strategies to revitalize the Michif language did you discover in your research? Why do many Métis consider the ability to speak Michif culturally significant?” “How might the standardization of Inuktitut affect the revitalization and/or strengthening of the language?”

C2.5 analyse some forms and uses of contemporary technology, media, and popular culture (e.g., *video clips, online tutorials, video games, apps, podcasts, hashtags, Heritage minutes, commercially released films*) in terms of how they support and/or promote First Nations, Métis, and Inuit knowledge, world views, aspirations, and actions

Sample questions: “How does the app Honour Water promote Anishinaabe knowledge, world views, and aspirations?” “Who is the target audience of the radio show *Unreserved*? What techniques does it use to reach this audience, and how does it promote First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views?” “Which decolonization goals do you think Wapikoni Mobile is attempting to support? What evidence can you give?” “How did the hashtag #makemuskratright help Innu in Labrador raise awareness about environmental issues related to the Muskrat Falls dam?”

D. RECLAMATION AND RECONCILIATION

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Reclaiming Traditional Beliefs, Values, and Customs:** demonstrate an understanding of how individuals, families, institutions, and communities are reclaiming a place for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs, values, and customs in contemporary life;
- D2. Truth, Reconciliation, and Renewal:** demonstrate an understanding of how building recognition and respect for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit knowledge, world views, and aspirations contributes to truth, reconciliation, and renewed nation-to-nation relationships;
- D3. Aspirations and Social Action:** demonstrate an understanding of how key First Nations, Métis, and Inuit aspirations for communities, for Canada, and for global society reflect traditional and contemporary beliefs and values, and analyse the role of social action in supporting those goals.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Reclaiming Traditional Beliefs, Values, and Customs

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** explain the function of some individual roles associated with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs, values, and customs (*e.g., Elders and Métis Senators teach community members about traditions and culture; healing dancers perform ceremonial dances to promote the spiritual and physical health of the community; sweat lodge conductors direct participants through purification ceremonies to cleanse the body, mind, and soul*), and identify several different strategies to ensure the continued importance of these roles in the community (*e.g., offering traditional healing and traditional counselling through Indigenous health centres, teaching cultural knowledge and values through Indigenous-led community-based programs for children and youth*)

Sample questions: “What is the role of a First Nation pipe carrier?” “Which cultures have a head veteran? What role does that person play in the community?” “What can community health centres do to support Indigenous beliefs and values? Who might they approach to help in this effort?” “What is the function of Métis captains of the hunt? Why is this role relevant to contemporary life?”

- D1.2** analyse some strategies to integrate traditional knowledge and customs into contemporary life for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities to identify a few benefits and challenges related to these efforts (*e.g., benefits: traditional societies that teach spiritual practices such as smudging, prayer, and offering gifts provide Indigenous youth with spiritual support and guidance; incorporating traditional practices into name giving, birthing ceremonies, funerals, and other rites of passage connects individuals to their cultural identity and to other community members; challenges: individuals may lack access to cultural advisors and/or opportunities to interact with like-minded individuals; First Nations, Métis, and Inuit may face public lack of understanding when attempting to exercise their collective right to harvest animals and plants for subsistence; families may not have the financial resources to send children to schools that incorporate traditional practices*)

Sample questions: “What are the purposes and benefits of fasting? How might the custom of allowing children to fast challenge cross-cultural understanding?” “What programming do organizations such as the Ontario Federation of Indigenous Friendship Centres offer at the community level? How does this help Indigenous individuals and families reclaim their cultural beliefs, values, and customs?” “How does opening and closing an event with the Thanksgiving

Address or a similar cultural expression of spirituality complete the day of a belief adherent? Why does this practice remain relevant in contemporary life? What obstacles to this practice might individuals encounter?" "Why is it customary to acknowledge the land on which any meeting or gathering is held? What is being reclaimed in the process? What symbolism is involved in this practice?" "What is the role of the Métis Nation of Ontario Healing and Wellness Branch? In what ways are its activities grounded in traditional knowledge?"

- D1.3** identify several different programs and initiatives to reclaim a place for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs, values, and customs in education in Canada (*e.g., Laurentian University has mandated that all students taking a bachelor of arts degree take at least one course with Indigenous content; some Canadian universities have signed a declaration to uphold the recommendations of the Truth and Reconciliation Commission; schools are inviting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit community members, including Elders, to share their knowledge and participate in the school community; school boards and other community groups are providing intercultural capacity training for educators*), and explain how such efforts can influence society

Sample questions: "How are Ontario high schools attempting to support First Nations, Métis, and Inuit knowledge and world views that have been eroded by colonization? Why do these efforts benefit all students?" "Which Canadian educational institutions offer Elder-in-residence programs? What is the purpose of such programs?" "How are First Nations, Métis, and Inuit beliefs, values, and customs being incorporated into your own education? How does that affect your world view?"

D2. Truth, Reconciliation, and Renewal

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** make and explain some connections between First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural observances/events and the goals of truth, reconciliation, and renewal (*e.g., festivals offer a setting for vendors to explain the cultural and spiritual messages of art works by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals; powwows provide a public forum for sharing traditional knowledge through storytelling; country-wide Rendezvous events encourage wider understanding of Métis culture; harvest camps strengthen Indigenous ecological knowledge and promote understanding of the connection between the people and the land*)

Sample questions: "What connections can you make between cultural understanding and reconciliation?" "In your opinion, how does learning about a culture through reading or watching a documentary differ from learning through participating in a cultural event?"

- D2.2** identify and describe several different ways in which efforts to promote First Nations, Métis, and Inuit environmental knowledge and perspectives have contributed to truth, reconciliation, and renewal (*e.g., land recovery projects for the protection of indigenous seeds and naturally grown foods engage Canadian society in the connection between the people and the land; water walks raise awareness of the necessity of clean water and the importance of respecting water as a gift from the natural world*)

Sample questions: "What are some ways in which Indigenous communities have drawn attention to the depletion of wild salmon stocks? How do these actions follow or diverge from the principles expressed in the Haudenosaunee Two Row Wampum? How are they connected to truth and reconciliation?" "What have Josephine Mandamin's water walks drawn attention to? How do her efforts support reconciliation and renewal?"

- D2.3** analyse some government policies and actions in Canada intended to affirm truth, reconciliation, and renewal related to decolonization to determine the key commitments of these policies/actions and identify some results (*e.g., with reference to the Royal Commission on Aboriginal Peoples; the responses of provincial governments to the calls to action expressed in the Final Report of the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada; Canada's statement of support for the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples*)

Sample questions: "What specific commitments have provincial governments made as a result of the Truth and Reconciliation Commission's calls to action? How have these commitments affected your own education? What examples can you give?"

- D2.4** analyse some judicial/legal actions in Canada intended to affirm truth, reconciliation, and renewal related to Aboriginal title, treaty rights, and nation-to-nation relationships to determine the key stakeholders and processes involved in these actions (*e.g., land claim interactions take place between First Nations, Métis, or Inuit governments and organizations and provincial or federal governments, and involve re-examining and reappraising the historical*

record with respect to traditional territories; land claim settlements require a reconciliation of stakeholders' competing values and aspirations; the Constitution Act, 1982, enshrines some Aboriginal rights, such as hunting and fishing rights, within law)

Sample questions: “How does Canadian federal law use the concept of ‘Aboriginal title’ when defining inherent right to land or territory? What is the relationship between Crown land and land with Aboriginal title? Why is this relevant for nation-to-nation relationships?” “Who are the stakeholders in land claims? Why do you think that land claim settlements often become prominent media stories? What kind of information does a media release about a land claim settlement typically contain?”

D3. Aspirations and Social Action

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 identify and describe some aspirations that First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and organizations characterize as important for communities, for Canada, and for global society (e.g., for communities: *building relationships between municipalities and First Nations communities; ensuring access to adequate housing, health, and education services; preservation of Indigenous ways of life, including harvesting rights*; for Canada: *protection of traditional lands and water; reconciliation and renewed nation-to-nation relationships; an equal voice for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities in social and political decision making*; for global society: *respect for Indigenous human rights around the world, environmentally responsible practices*), and make inferences about how these aspirations reflect both traditional and contemporary values

Sample questions: “What are some shared aspirations of Indigenous youth in communities across Canada? What values do you think motivate these goals?” “What are some risks associated with contaminated water in First Nations communities across Canada? How

are First Nations women addressing this issue, and how do their actions reflect both traditional values and social change?” “What kinds of resources do remote communities need to meet their common aspirations? Why might a community lack these resources?” “How have oil and gas pipelines changed the relationship between land and people? How has the presence of pipelines on traditional First Nations and Inuit territories affected community aspirations?”

D3.2 interpret and explain the goals of several different social initiatives to support First Nations, Métis, and Inuit aspirations (e.g., *Indigenous patient navigators provide support and advocacy for patients and their families by coordinating culturally responsive services; job training and entrepreneurship programs for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit youth provide work experience and information about career options and opportunities*), identifying some achievements and continuing challenges

Sample questions: “Why do you think a summer career placement program was designed specifically for Métis youth in Ontario? What successes has the program had?” “What unique supports do urban Indigenous health centres offer to Indigenous families? What challenges do urban Indigenous communities still face with respect to ensuring culturally responsive local health services? How might these challenges be addressed?”